

# DOMINION BUREAU OF STATISTICS

## HEALTH AND WELFARE DIVISION

Summary of Cases of Notifiable Diseases in Canada, as reported by the Provincial Health Departments

for the week ended July 28, 1956, in comparison with the previous week<sup>1</sup>, and the 5-year (1951-55) Median

| No. | DISEASE                                  | CANADA <sup>2</sup> |               |                |                               |        |                | NFLD.       |               |                | P.E.I.      |               |                | N.S.        |               |                | N.B.        |               |                | QUE.        |               |                | ONT.        |               |                | MAN.        |               |                | SASK.       |               |                | ALTA.       |               |                | B.C. |    |    | No. |
|-----|------------------------------------------|---------------------|---------------|----------------|-------------------------------|--------|----------------|-------------|---------------|----------------|-------------|---------------|----------------|-------------|---------------|----------------|-------------|---------------|----------------|-------------|---------------|----------------|-------------|---------------|----------------|-------------|---------------|----------------|-------------|---------------|----------------|-------------|---------------|----------------|------|----|----|-----|
|     |                                          | Report Week         | Previous Week | Median 1951-55 | Cumulative Total <sup>3</sup> |        |                | Report Week | Previous Week | Median 1951-55 | Report Week | Previous Week | Median 1951-55 | Report Week | Previous Week | Median 1951-55 | Report Week | Previous Week | Median 1951-55 | Report Week | Previous Week | Median 1951-55 | Report Week | Previous Week | Median 1951-55 | Report Week | Previous Week | Median 1951-55 | Report Week | Previous Week | Median 1951-55 | Report Week | Previous Week | Median 1951-55 |      |    |    |     |
|     |                                          |                     |               |                | 1956                          | 1955   | Median 1951-55 |             |               |                |             |               |                |             |               |                |             |               |                |             |               |                |             |               |                |             |               |                |             |               |                |             |               |                |      |    |    |     |
| 1   | Chickenpox                               | 226                 | 301           | 270            | 25,900                        | 23,947 | 31,501         | 1           | 12            | 2              | -           | 1             | 9              | 9           | 18            | 13             | ..          | ..            | ..             | 54          | 112           | 29             | 109         | 88            | 82             | 12          | 4             | 13             | ..          | ..            | 20             | ..          | ..            | ..             | 41   | 66 | 31 | 1   |
| 2   | Diphtheria                               | 3                   | 4             | 1              | 59                            | 61     | 86             | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | 3           | 3             | 1              | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | -           | 1             | -              | -    | -  | 2  |     |
| 3   | Dysentery: <sup>4</sup>                  | 9                   | 20            | 15             | 366                           | 331    | 331            | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | ..          | ..            | ..             | ..          | ..            | ..             | -           | 2             | 2              | -           | -             | -              | -           | 3             | -              | -           | 1             | -              | 9    | 14 | 7  | 3   |
| 4   | (a) Amoebic                              | -                   | -             | -              | -                             | 2      | 7              | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | ..          | ..            | ..             | ..          | ..            | ..             | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | -    | -  | 4  |     |
| 5   | (b) Bacillary                            | 9                   | 20            | 15             | 366                           | 329    | 329            | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | ..          | ..            | ..             | ..          | ..            | ..             | -           | 2             | 2              | -           | -             | -              | -           | 3             | -              | -           | 1             | -              | 9    | 14 | 7  | 5   |
| 6   | Encephalitis, infectious                 | 1                   | -             | -              | 11                            | 14     | 19             | -           | -             | -              | ..          | ..            | ..             | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | ..          | ..            | ..             | 1           | ..            | ..             | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | -    | -  | 6  |     |
| 7   | Influenza, epidemic                      | 64                  | 127           | 13             | 8,382                         | 36,199 | 8,943          | ..          | ..            | ..             | 61          | 84            | ..             | 2           | 34            | 12             | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | 1           | 9             | -              | -           | -             | 1              | -           | -             | -              | ..          | ..            | ..             | -    | -  | -  | 7   |
| 8   | Measles                                  | 396                 | 554           | 365            | 39,962                        | 42,531 | 46,266         | 3           | 2             | 2              | -           | 1             | 7              | 33          | 30            | 7              | ..          | ..            | ..             | 73          | 254           | 80             | 184         | 180           | 75             | 18          | 7             | 17             | ..          | ..            | 10             | 37          | 28            | 42             | 48   | 52 | 60 | 8   |
| 9   | Meningitis, meningococcal                | 4                   | 1             | 1              | 182                           | 184    | 169            | 1           | -             | -              | ..          | ..            | ..             | -           | -             | -              | 1           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | 2           | 1             | -              | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | ..             | ..          | ..            | -              | -    | -  | 9  |     |
| 10  | Mumps                                    | 150                 | 138           | 169            | 21,059                        | 19,374 | 27,677         | -           | -             | 1              | -           | 4             | -              | 1           | -             | 4              | ..          | ..            | ..             | 17          | 24            | 14             | 110         | 77            | 82             | 4           | 4             | 7              | ..          | 2             | 7              | ..          | ..            | 13             | 18   | 27 | 22 | 10  |
| 11  | Poliomyelitis, epidemic: <sup>4</sup>    | 8                   | 12            | 119            | 101                           | 256    | 391            | -           | -             | 1              | -           | -             | 1              | -           | -             | 1              | -           | -             | -              | 3           | 3             | 8              | -           | 2             | 47             | -           | -             | 4              | -           | 1             | 4              | 3           | 8             | 2              | 3    | 7  | 11 |     |
| 12  | (a) With paralysis                       | 5                   | 7             | 45             | 62                            | 141    | 142            | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | 1              | -           | -             | -              | 3           | 3             | 6              | -           | 1             | 10             | -           | -             | 4              | -           | (6)           | 1              | 1           | 3             | 2              | 1    | -  | 2  | 12  |
| 13  | (b) Without paralysis                    | 3                   | 4             | 73             | 31                            | 100    | 157            | -           | -             | 1              | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | 3              | -           | 1             | 37             | -           | -             | 1              | -           | (6)           | 2              | 2           | -             | 2              | 1    | 3  | 4  | 13  |
| 14  | Rubella                                  | 160                 | 251           | 40             | 48,493                        | 17,211 | 8,854          | -           | -             | -              | ..          | ..            | ..             | 10          | 8             | 2              | ..          | ..            | ..             | 36          | 111           | 5              | 60          | 49            | 9              | -           | -             | 1              | ..          | ..            | 1              | 8           | 16            | 15             | 46   | 67 | 7  | 14  |
| 15  | Scarlet fever, etc. <sup>5</sup>         | 90                  | 117           | 104            | 8,495                         | 6,101  | 9,199          | -           | 3             | 2              | 20          | 25            | 4              | 14          | 12            | 12             | -           | 21            | -              | 12          | 16            | 15             | 23          | 29            | 18             | -           | 1             | 6              | 11          | 1             | 12             | 2           | 3             | 6              | 8    | 6  | 13 | 15  |
| 16  | Smallpox                                 | -                   | -             | -              | -                             | -      | -              | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | -    | -  | 16 |     |
| 17  | Tuberculosis: <sup>4</sup>               | 194                 | 247           | 214            | 5,350                         | 5,572  | 6,075          | 24          | 3             | 8              | 1           | 3             | 2              | -           | -             | 2              | 12          | 15            | 19             | 83          | 155           | 75             | 17          | 11            | 23             | 11          | 13            | 19             | 7           | -             | 7              | 17          | 29            | 28             | 22   | 18 | 30 | 17  |
| 18  | (a) Pulmonary                            | 165                 | 218           | 175            | 4,382                         | 4,524  | 4,892          | 23          | 3             | 8              | 1           | 2             | 1              | -           | -             | 2              | 11          | 14            | 19             | 77          | 149           | 69             | (6)         | (6)           | (6)            | 9           | 12            | 19             | 7           | -             | 4              | 16          | 22            | 27             | 21   | 16 | 26 | 18  |
| 19  | (b) Non-pulmonary                        | 12                  | 18            | 14             | 320                           | 371    | 310            | 1           | -             | -              | -           | 1             | -              | -           | -             | -              | 1           | 1             | -              | 6           | 6             | 4              | (6)         | (6)           | (6)            | 2           | 1             | -              | -           | -             | 3              | 1           | 7             | 2              | 1    | 2  | 4  | 19  |
| 20  | Typhoid and paratyphoid                  | 15                  | 1             | 10             | 234                           | 162    | 242            | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | 4           | -             | 4              | 1           | -             | 1              | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | 7              | -           | -             | 3              | 1    | -  | 20 |     |
| 21  | Undulant fever                           | 4                   | -             | 4              | 82                            | 70     | 72             | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | ..          | ..            | ..             | ..          | ..            | ..             | 2           | 3             | -              | -           | 1             | -              | -           | -             | ..             | ..          | ..            | -              | -    | -  | -  | 21  |
| 22  | Venereal diseases:                       | 313                 | 299           | 385            | 9,176                         | 9,643  | 10,142         | 8           | 11            | 8              | 2           | 1             | 1              | 4           | 5             | 10             | 7           | 5             | 5              | 70          | 85            | 114            | 35          | 41            | 64             | 20          | 18            | 28             | 32          | 36            | 34             | 56          | 57            | 56             | 79   | 40 | 66 | 22  |
| 23  | (a) Syphilis, primary                    | -                   | 4             | 5              | 59                            | 62     | 123            | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | 3           | 1             | -              | 1    | -  | 23 |     |
| 24  | (b) " secondary                          | 2                   | -             | 2              | 25                            | 23     | 71             | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | 1           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | 1           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | -    | -  | 24 |     |
| 25  | (c) " other                              | 29                  | 46            | 40             | 1,080                         | 1,393  | 1,566          | -           | -             | -              | -           | 1             | -              | -           | 5             | 1              | -           | -             | 1              | 20          | 18            | 9              | 3           | 12            | 15             | 1           | 1             | 2              | 1           | -             | 1              | -           | 5             | 2              | 4    | 4  | 5  | 25  |
| 26  | (d) Gonorrhoea                           | 282                 | 249           | 318            | 8,010                         | 8,151  | 8,194          | 8           | 11            | 5              | 2           | -             | 1              | 4           | -             | 10             | 7           | 5             | 4              | 49          | 67            | 66             | 32          | 29            | 52             | 18          | 17            | 23             | 31          | 36            | 33             | 56          | 49            | 53             | 75   | 35 | 62 | 26  |
| 27  | (e) Other venereal diseases <sup>7</sup> | -                   | -             | -              | 2                             | 14     | 13             | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | -           | -             | -              | -    | -  | 27 |     |
| 28  | Whooping cough                           | 130                 | 112           | 126            | 4,919                         | 7,704  | 4,794          | -           | -             | -              | 11          | 1             | 1              | -           | -             | 6              | 1           | -             | -              | 57          | 67            | 35             | 10          | 14            | 38             | 14          | 6             | 2              | -           | 3             | 4              | 6           | 2             | 8              | 31   | 19 | 22 | 28  |

(1) Figures adjusted for delayed reports. (2) Exclusive of Yukon and Northwest Territories. (3) Total accumulated to the end of the current week from the first week ending in January of the year stated. (4) Includes cases where type was not specified. (5) Scarlet fever includes cases of streptococcal sore throat; streptococcal sore throat not reportable in New Brunswick and Quebec. (6) Type not specified. (7) Includes chancroid, granuloma inguinale and lymphogranuloma venereum. .. Not reportable.

THE SITUATION IN THE UNITED STATES (Source: "MORBIDITY AND MORTALITY-WEEKLY REPORT", U.S. National Office of Vital Statistics): Number of reported cases for the current week (previous week in parentheses):

Diphtheria 25 ( 15 ); Measles 3,416 (5,190); Meningitis, other 29 ( 44 ); Poliomyelitis, with paralysis 288 ( 279 ); Smallpox - ( - ); Undulant fever 20 ( 26 ); Encephalitis infectious 52 ( 39 ); Meningococcal infections 30 ( 45 ); Poliomyelitis, acute 658 ( 533 ); Poliomyelitis, without paralysis 258 ( 182 ); Typhoid fever 52 ( 49 );

The number of poliomyelitis cases reported for the current week is 658 as compared with 1,034 for the same period last year. The proportion of paralytic cases so far in 1956 has been about 50 per cent of the total as compared with about 40 per cent last year. The percentage of non-paralytic cases has been about the same, and the unspecified cases have been lower, both in numbers and proportionately, this year as compared with 1955. The larger proportion of paralytic cases probably is due in part to the greater concentration of cases under 5 years of age in certain states, in which age group paralytic cases normally are proportionately greater. Reports from a few states show that the percentage of cases in the 5. to 9 year group has been small in 1956. This group was first to receive poliomyelitis vaccine. The smaller number of unspecified cases indicate that more complete information is being received by states at the time cases are reported.